

INTRODUCTION

On January 9, 2007, the world changed as we know it. No, we're not talking terrorism or major political upheavals... it was the day the iPhone was launched. It was the first time people had seen a device that boasted the touch interfaces we all take for granted today.

Today, with over 4,25,000 third-party apps (some reports suggest over 5 lakh) in the App Store you can do anything on your iOS device from playing Angry Birds to preliminary medical diagnosis. Even with the limited processing power, memory, and screen estate, these iOS devices – iPhones, iPod touches and the newer iPads – have become an indispensable tool in our everyday lives. The iPhone represented a new direction for Apple – and, it turns out, the cell phone industry as a whole. What's interesting to note is that the iPad actually came first – Apple started working on a tablet operating system, and decided that it was also perfect for a phone, and apparently easier to implement, because the phone came out first.

This Fast Track will walk those of you who are new to iOS through its basic features, and make you a pro. We will also cover default applications and some of the best third-party applications that you can access from the App Store. From setting up your brand new iOS device to watching videos and a lot more, it's all here. 